Students Studying in Canada

CO-OP WORK PERMIT



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CO-OP WORK PERMIT

If work experience is included as part of your program curriculum, you need to apply for a co-op work permit (https://nam12.safelinks.protection.outlook.com/?url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.canada.ca%2Fen%2Fimmigration-refugees-citizenship%2Fservices%2Fstudy-canada%2Fwork%2Fintern.html&data=04%7C01%7Cj.perolio%40northeastern.edu%7C7896011e82c44d727ea808d8b80b5627%7Ca8eec281aaa34daeac9b9a398b9215e7%7C0%7C0%7C637461706123667674%7CUnknown%7CTWFpbGZsb3d8eyJWIjoiMC4wLjAwMDAiLCJQIjoiV2luMzIiLCJBTiI6Ik1haWwiLCJXVC

I6Mn0%3D%7C1000&sdata=nYXu6vJyO3KACPvrH6QsmlAJ4QuVvCC1%2BboX9QtzuDU%3D&reserved=0). A co-op work permit allows students to work full-time during regular academic terms. You must have a co-op work permit and a Social Insurance Number (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs-ca/student-support/global-campuses/canada/social-insurance-number/) **before** you start your co-op. You also need to meet the college co-op program criteria before you may start your co-op.

You may apply for a co-op work permit in two ways:

- With your initial Study Permit (recommended)
  - You may upload your POA document as your "School Letter" to the IRCC portal. You may be given a Co-op permit at the border with your Study Permit.

- In Canada after you receive your Study Permit approval and have started your program.
  - It is a free application, and you may contact the international student advisor to request a School Letter to support your application. Please allow time for processing.
  - It is recommended to apply for a co-op work permit at least 3-4 months before your co-op term starts.

You may not start your co-op position without a valid co-op work permit. In Canada, you also need a Social Insurance Number (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs-ca/student-support/global-campuses/canada/social-insurance-number/) to work.

Co-op Requirements:

After you get your co-op permit, it is your responsibility to ensure that your co-op opportunity meets all the compliance requirements. The regulatory requirements are:

- Full time (30+ hours/ week)
- Must be registered in co-op course
- Co-op duration must be approximately equal to the academic term duration

Please also note that you cannot start a co-op without the University's approval. You must speak with your Career and Co-Op Advisor before securing any co-op position.

Watch: Co-op Work Permit Application Tutorial

If you are a current student already in Canada and enrolled in classes at Northeastern, please watch the step-by-step tutorial in our self-enrol Canvas course, **OGS Canadian Immigration Application Guides and Tutorials** (https://northeastern.instructure.com/enroll/R7A737), for instructions on how to apply for your Co-op Work Permit.

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